EXECUTIVE BRIEFING

Medicaid Access Monitor

Which states left Medicaid callers waiting the longest during unwinding, and what should Florida do about it?

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Live dashboard: medicaid-access-monitor.streamlit.app
GitHub: github.com/villegasjv55/medicaid-access-monitor

WHY IT MATTERS

Millions had to renew. Many couldn't get through.

- From **2023 to 2024**, every state had to re-check Medicaid eligibility for everyone enrolled ("unwinding").
- Millions of people called state call centers to renew. When they can't get through, eligible people can lose coverage for paperwork reasons.
- **CMS published monthly call-center data** for every state: calls, average wait, and the share of callers who hung up.
- This project cleans that data, checks it three ways (Python, SQL, Excel), and turns it into a ranking, a Florida spotlight and recommendations.

154.7M

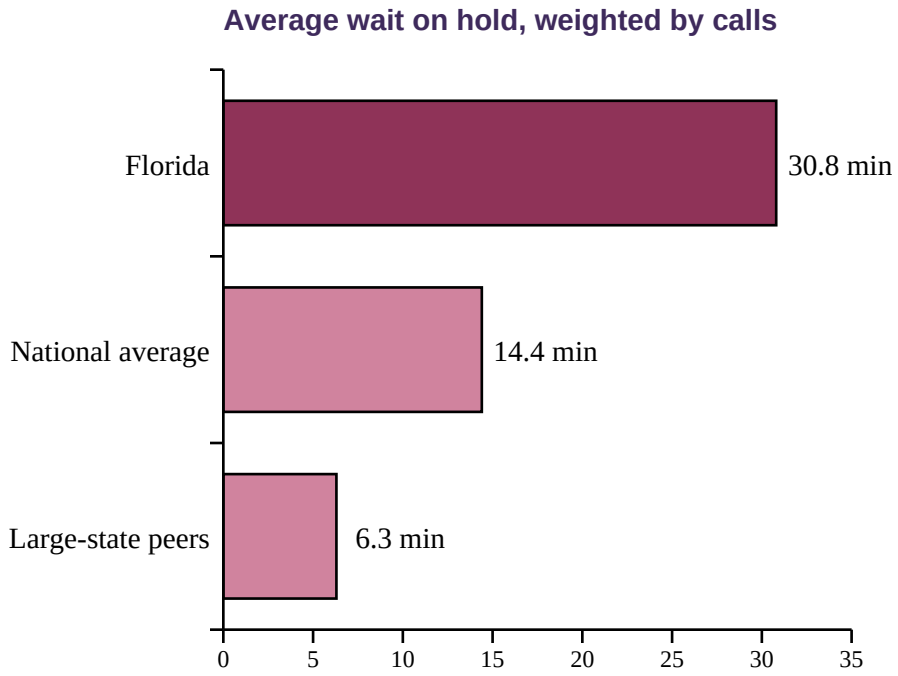
calls to Medicaid call centers, 50 states + DC, 17 months

18.4%

of callers nationally hung up before reaching anyone

KEY FINDING

Florida callers waited 2x the nation and 5x the big states



#3 of 50

Florida's rank for worst access (risk score)

37%

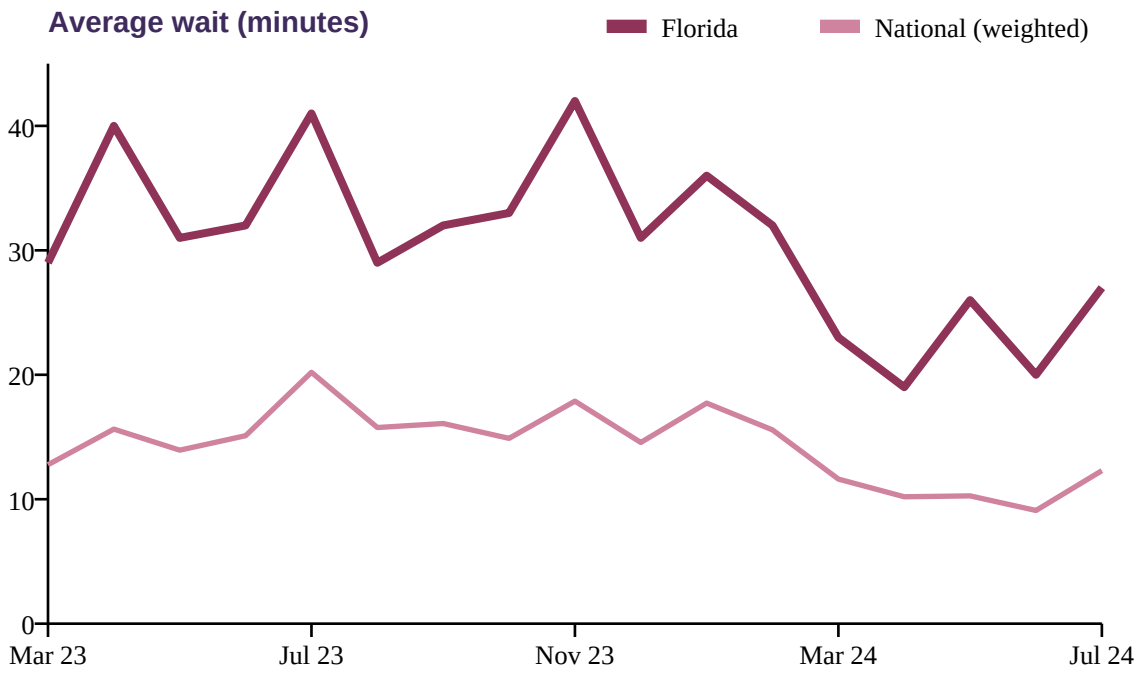
of Florida callers hung up: about 13.4 million calls

17 of 17

months with Florida's wait over 15 minutes

THE TREND

Bad every month, with a little improvement in 2024



- Worst months: **Nov 2023** (42 min), **Jul 2023** (41), **Apr 2023** (40, with 50% hanging up).
- Florida ranked **2nd to 8th worst** every single month.
- 2024 was better: **34.1** → **26.7 min**, but still about 2x the nation.

WHAT DRIVES IT

Calls follow renewals, and Florida had the heaviest load

0.94

correlation between monthly calls and renewals due (national): peaks are predictable

487

Florida calls per 1,000 enrollees per month, highest in the U.S. (next: Utah, 314)

23%

of all U.S. Medicaid call-center calls went to Florida

Recovery is possible. Other states cut waits by 30+ minutes from their peak:

- **Maine:** 44 → under 6 minutes
- **Oklahoma:** 46 → under 10 minutes
- **Idaho:** 56 → under 19 minutes

Note: across states, phone access and paperwork terminations were only weakly related (0.13). These are patterns, not causes.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Five moves to get Florida's callers through

1 Staff to the renewal calendar

Forecast weekly calls from renewals due; schedule agents 4–6 weeks ahead; overflow capacity for peaks.

2 Cut avoidable calls

More automatic renewals, plain-language notices, self-service status checks (web, text, IVR).

3 Stop losing callers in the queue

Virtual callback after 10 minutes; expected-wait message at the start of each call.

4 Manage to weekly targets

Wait under 15 min, abandonment under 15%, calls per 1,000 tracked weekly with named owners.

5 Learn from recovered states

Talk to Maine, Oklahoma and Idaho about what cut their waits so fast.

NEXT STEPS (SIMULATED SCENARIO)

A 12-week pilot, tracked every week

SIMULATED: a practice rollout plan. The baseline is real (Florida Jan–Jul 2024); the weekly results are invented to show how I'd track it.

KPI	Real baseline	Week 12 (simulated)	Target
Average wait	26.7 min	13.0 min	≤ 15 min (met)
Callers who hung up	35.1%	15.5%	≤ 15% (not yet)
Calls per 1,000 enrollees (weekly)	112	93	-15% (met)
Tasks complete	—	11 of 14	14 of 14

How the numbers were checked: Python, SQL and Excel all give 867 state-months · 154,681,330 calls · 28,472,216 abandoned calls. 417 data issues logged, none hidden.

Explore it: medicaid-access-monitor.streamlit.app · github.com/villegasjv55/medicaid-access-monitor